ARIES EDUCATIONAL TRUST

BL-43, SYLVAN COUNTY, MAHINDRA WORLD CITY, CHENGALPATTU- 603004
Email: aries.edutrust@gmail.com

Serial No: AET/CC/001

ARIES POLYTECHNIC COLLEGE

(Managed by Aries Educational Trust)

Code of Conduct for Faculty and Staff Members

1. Purpose and Scope

This Code of Conduct establishes the standards of professional behaviour, ethical integrity, discipline, and accountability expected of all faculty members, administrative staff, technical personnel, and support staff of Aries Polytechnic College (hereinafter collectively referred to as "faculty and staff members"). This Code shall apply at all times during working hours, while on campus or institutional premises, during official assignments, and whenever a faculty or staff member represents the institution in any capacity.

2. Institutional Loyalty and Exclusive Service

All faculty and staff members shall render exclusive service to Aries Polytechnic College and shall devote their full professional time, competence, and attention to the duties assigned by the Management. No faculty or staff member shall, directly or indirectly, engage in any other employment, private tuition, consultancy, trade, business, profession, or part-time work without prior written approval from the competent authority. Any unauthorized engagement shall constitute misconduct.

3. Outside Engagements and Professional Activities

No faculty or staff member shall undertake external academic, professional, or commercial assignments, including consultancy, guest lectures, training programs, or advisory roles, without explicit written permission from the Management. Approved engagements shall not interfere with institutional responsibilities or compromise the interests, reputation, or discipline of the College.

4. Performance of Duties and Workplace Discipline

Faculty and staff members are expected to perform their duties with diligence, integrity, punctuality, accountability, and devotion. During working hours, they shall strictly engage only in official academic, administrative, technical, or operational

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activities. Engaging in non-work-related activities during working hours is strictly prohibited.

5. Use of Communication Devices and Digital Resources

The use of mobile phones and electronic devices for personal calls, messaging, social media, or entertainment during working hours within classrooms, laboratories, workshops, offices, hostels, or other campus premises is strictly prohibited, except in emergencies or when officially authorized. Institutional IT resources shall be used responsibly and exclusively for official & college purposes only.

6. Confidentiality and Data Protection

All faculty and staff members shall maintain strict confidentiality regarding institutional information, including but not limited to student records, examination materials, assessment data, academic documents, administrative files, financial records, internal communications, and strategic information. Any unauthorized disclosure, misuse, or sharing of confidential information shall be treated as serious misconduct.

7. Compensation and Service Information Confidentiality

Information relating to salary, allowances, incentives, benefits, service conditions, or personal records of faculty and staff members is strictly confidential. Such information shall not be disclosed, discussed, or compared with others within or outside the institution.

8. Photography, Recording, and Social Media Conduct

Photography, videography, audio recording, or digital documentation within the College premises or during institutional activities is strictly prohibited without prior written authorization from the Management. Faculty and staff members shall not publish, circulate, or share any content related to the College, its students, staff, infrastructure, or internal matters on social media or digital platforms without official approval.

9. Gifts, Gratification, and Conflict of Interest

No faculty or staff member shall solicit, accept, or offer gifts, cash, favors, commissions, or any form of gratification from students, parents, vendors,

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contractors, service providers, or any external stakeholders. Any actual or potential conflict of interest shall be disclosed immediately to the Management.

10. Professional Conduct and Workplace Harmony

Faculty and staff members shall maintain professional decorum, mutual respect, discipline, and dignity in all interactions. Interference in disputes, grievances, or matters beyond one's official role, or any conduct that disrupts institutional harmony, authority, or discipline, is strictly prohibited.

11. Ethical Standards and Institutional Representation

Faculty and staff members shall conduct themselves in a manner that upholds the reputation, values, academic integrity, and public image of Aries Polytechnic College at all times, both within and outside the institution. Any conduct unbecoming of a faculty or staff member or any act that brings disrepute to the institution shall invite disciplinary action.

12. Compliance with Policies and Statutory Requirements

All faculty and staff members shall strictly comply with institutional rules, academic regulations, administrative orders, statutory requirements, and lawful instructions issued by the Management from time to time.

13. Disciplinary Action

Any violation of this Code of Conduct shall be viewed seriously. Depending on the nature and gravity of the misconduct, disciplinary action may include counselling, warning, written reprimand, suspension, withholding of increments, termination of service, or any other action deemed appropriate by the Management, in accordance with institutional rules and applicable laws.

14. Interpretation and Amendment

The Management of Aries Polytechnic College reserves the exclusive right to interpret, modify, amend, or supplement this Code of Conduct as and when required. The decision of the Management in this regard shall be final and binding on all faculty and staff members.

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Disciplinary Proceedings and Misconduct Policy

1. Objective and Applicability

This policy defines acts of misconduct, disciplinary procedures, and penalties applicable to all faculty members, administrative staff, technical staff, and support staff of Aries Polytechnic College (hereinafter referred to as "Faculty and Staff Members").

The objective of this policy is to ensure academic discipline, professional conduct, ethical integrity, institutional harmony, and a safe and respectful campus environment.

This policy shall apply to conduct occurring:

- Within the College campus and premises
- During working hours or official duties
- During College-related activities, programs, or assignments
- Outside the campus, where such conduct adversely affects the reputation, discipline, or interests of the College

2. Definition of Misconduct

Misconduct shall include any act, omission, or behaviour inconsistent with the duties, responsibilities, or ethical standards expected of faculty and staff members. Without limiting the general meaning of misconduct, the following acts shall constitute misconduct:

A. Discipline, Attendance, and Obedience

- Wilful disobedience, insubordination, or refusal to comply with lawful and reasonable instructions of superiors
- Habitual late attendance or irregular attendance
- Unauthorized absence from duty or continuous absence exceeding three (3) consecutive working days without approval
- Recording attendance on behalf of another person or allowing proxy attendance

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- Refusal to accept official communications, notices, charge sheets, or lawful orders

B. Academic and Administrative Integrity

- Neglect of teaching responsibilities, administrative duties, or assigned institutional work
- Persistent non-compliance with workload, academic schedules, or institutional requirements
- Engaging in private tuition, consultancy, or any other employment while in service without prior written approval
- Performing personal or private work during working hours using College resources

C. Misuse of College Property and Resources

- Theft, fraud, dishonesty, or misappropriation of college property, funds, or records
- Wilful or negligent damage to college buildings, laboratories, equipment, library materials, or infrastructure
- Misuse or wastage of electricity, water, internet, or other institutional resources
- Unauthorized access to, disclosure of, or tampering with confidential academic or administrative information

D. Campus Discipline and Conduct

- Disorderly, disruptive, abusive, threatening, coercive, or violent behaviour
- Use of abusive language, intimidation, or harassment of students, colleagues, or management
- Sleeping during working hours
- Loitering, idleness, or unauthorized presence on campus beyond permitted hours

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- Spitting, unhygienic behaviour, or violation of campus cleanliness norms

E. Safety, Security, and Prohibited Activities

- Non-compliance with safety rules, laboratory protocols, workshop instructions, or standard safety procedures
- Tampering with safety devices, equipment, or emergency systems
- Possession of weapons on campus without authorization
- Gambling, money lending, chit funds, or loan collection within College premises
- Possession, consumption, or influence of alcohol, narcotics, or intoxicating substances on campus
- Use of tobacco in any form within college premises

F. Information, Communication, and Reputation

- Unauthorized photography, videography, audio recording, or digital documentation within college premises
- Publishing, sharing, or circulating unauthorized content related to the College on social media or digital platforms
- Dissemination of false, malicious, defamatory, or misleading statements against the College, its management, faculty, staff, or students
- Display or circulation of posters, pamphlets, notices, or digital material without prior approval

G. Ethical, Legal, and Moral Violations

- Acceptance or offering of bribes, gifts, or illegal gratification
- Sexual harassment or any behaviour prohibited under applicable laws
- Conviction for a criminal offence involving moral turpitude by a court of law
- Submission of false information, forged documents, or misrepresentation at any stage of service

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- Participation in political activities or contesting elections using College name, time, or resources

3. Procedure for Unauthorized Absence

In cases of continuous unauthorized absence exceeding three (3) working days:

a) First Show Cause Notice

Issued by the Administration Office on the fourth day, directing the faculty or staff member to report immediately.

b) Second and Third Show Cause Notices

If there is no response, second and third notices shall be issued at intervals of one week each.

c) Removal from Service Rolls

Failure to report even after the third notice shall be treated as abandonment of service, and the name may be removed from the rolls of the College with Management approval.

4. Disciplinary Procedure

4.1 Issue of Charge Memorandum

A written charge memorandum specifying the acts of misconduct shall be served. A written explanation must be submitted within the stipulated time.

4.2 Domestic Inquiry

If the explanation is unsatisfactory, a domestic inquiry shall be conducted. The concerned faculty or staff member shall be:

- Informed of the date, time, and venue of the inquiry
- Given reasonable opportunity to present a defense
- Permitted to produce witnesses and cross-examine witnesses

An Inquiry Officer shall submit findings to the Disciplinary Authority for final decision.

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5. Findings and Penalties

Based on the findings, one or more of the following penalties may be imposed, depending on the gravity of misconduct:

- Warning or Censure
- Fine
- Suspension without pay (up to 30 days)
- Withholding or stoppage of increments
- Reduction in rank or pay scale
- Demotion
- Termination or dismissal from service

Before imposing major penalties, an opportunity to submit representations shall be provided, and a show-cause notice may be issued.

6. Treatment of Suspension Period

- If found guilty and dismissed or terminated, the suspension period shall be treated as non-duty.
- If a lesser penalty is imposed, the suspension period shall be treated as duty, with salary adjusted after deducting subsistence allowance.
- If exonerated, the entire suspension period shall be treated as duty with full pay and allowances.

7. Service of Notices

If a faculty or staff member refuses to accept notices or charge memoranda, the same shall be:

- Displayed on the College Notice Board, and
- Sent to the last known address

Such service shall be deemed valid. Failure to attend the inquiry may result in ex parte proceedings.

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Grievance Redressal and Complaints Committee

The College shall maintain a Grievance Redressal Committee to address complaints in a fair, confidential, and time-bound manner.

For matters relating to sexual harassment, the Committee shall:

- Be chaired by a woman
- Have not less than 50% women members
- Include one external member knowledgeable in gender and legal issues

The Committee shall function in accordance with applicable laws and statutory guidelines.

Uniform and Safety Measures

- It is mandatory for all faculty members, staff, and supporting personnel to strictly adhere to the prescribed uniform and required safety gear (where applicable) during working hours and while on campus or at institutional sites.
- Non-compliance with uniform or safety requirements shall attract disciplinary action as per the rules and regulations of Aries Educational Trust / Aries Polytechnic College.
- While using a motorized two-wheeler within the college campus or at institutional sites, all faculty, staff, and students are required to wear helmets. Failure to comply may result in denial of entry or access to the campus.
- While operating a four-wheeler within the college premises or at institutional sites, the use of seat belts is mandatory. Non-compliance may lead to denial of entry or appropriate disciplinary action.

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- To bring personal vehicles into the college campus, faculty and staff must apply to the Security Office and obtain a valid vehicle pass/permit. Vehicles shall be parked only in designated parking areas, and all campus traffic and safety regulations must be strictly followed.
- All faculty members, staff, and supporting personnel shall immediately report any injury or accident occurring during the course of duty within the campus or at institutional sites to the concerned Department Head / Reporting Authority. Injuries or incidents not reported promptly may not be considered for further action or benefits.

Authority and Interpretation

The Management of Aries Polytechnic College reserves the right to interpret, amend, or modify this policy as required. The decision of the Management shall be final and binding.

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